TABLE VI
CONCEPTUAL FOUNDATIONS OF THE KNOW–PROTECT–INFORM–ASSESS–VALIDATE–RESPOND CYCLE.

| Cycle action | Definition used in the catalogue | Principal supporting references | Connection to the references |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Know** | Understand the concern cluster, its context, intended purpose, affected stakeholders, applicable requirements, relevant assets or data, and potential sources of risk or impact. | **R-005** NIST AI RMF; **R-012** ISO 31000; **R-057** NIST CSF 2.0. | These frameworks establish context, identify stakeholders, assets, requirements and intended uses, and characterize relevant risks before controls are selected. |
| **Protect** | Implement proportionate technical, design, organizational or governance controls to prevent or reduce the identified risks and adverse impacts. | **R-020** NIST SSDF; **R-057** NIST CSF 2.0; **R-005** NIST AI RMF. | These references support selecting, implementing and maintaining safeguards according to the system's context and level of risk. |
| **Inform** | Communicate material practices, impacts, risks, limitations, choices and responsibilities to affected stakeholders in a clear, accessible and timely manner. | **R-001** Autili et al.; **R-005** NIST AI RMF; **R-012** ISO 31000. | These references support transparency, stakeholder communication and the disclosure of information needed for awareness, decision-making and accountability. |
| **Assess** | Evaluate relevant ethical risks, impacts and trade-offs before release and after material changes, and determine whether further treatment or safeguards are necessary. | **R-003** ISO/IEC/IEEE 24748-7000; **R-005** NIST AI RMF; **R-012** ISO 31000. | These references support addressing ethical concerns during design and systematically identifying, analysing, evaluating and treating risks and impacts throughout the lifecycle. |
| **Validate** | Confirm through review, testing, measurement or monitoring that the controls work, expected outcomes are being achieved, and claims about the system match its actual behaviour. | **R-005** NIST AI RMF; **R-020** NIST SSDF; **R-057** NIST CSF 2.0. | These frameworks support testing and evaluation, evidence collection, continuous monitoring and verification that implemented safeguards operate as intended. |
| **Respond** | Detect and address relevant issues in operation, contain and remediate adverse effects, provide appropriate escalation or redress, communicate where required, and use lessons learned to improve the next cycle. | **R-020** NIST SSDF; **R-057** NIST CSF 2.0; **R-005** NIST AI RMF. | These references support detecting operational problems, responding to incidents or adverse outcomes, mitigating consequences, correcting causes and improving future risk management. |

*Note:* The action definitions and the six-action structure constitute a catalogue-level synthesis rather than a process reproduced from a single source. The actions may overlap, recur and be revisited throughout the system lifecycle. The sequence provides practitioners with a simple navigation path and should not be interpreted as a mandatory linear process.